PP-H-91c
SEPTEMBER 2, 1958
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. PP–H–0091b
April 19, 1955 and
Fed. Spec. PP–H–91a
April 11, 1942

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

HASH; CORNED-BEEF, CANNED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers canned corned-beef hash as a meat food product that does not require refrigeration.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types.* — Canned corned-beef hash covered by this specification shall be of the following types and related formulas, can sizes, and net weight contents respectively, as specified or applicable (see 5.1.1 and 6.1).

Type I, Standard (commercially prepared and customarily available to large scale users and consumers and which is prepared without any special supervision (see 3.2.1).

Type II, Special (prepared under the direct supervision of especially assigned Government agents responsible for determining and assuring compliance with applicable requirements (see 3.2.2).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards.—The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

PPP–B–585—Boxes; Wood, Wirebound.
PPP–B–621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP–B–636—Boxes, Fiber.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL–L–1497 — Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items.
MIL–C–10506 — Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans.

Military Standard:

MIL–STD–129 — Marking for Shipment and Storage.

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(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. — The following documents form a part of this specification. Unless otherwise indicated, the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

Governmental:

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement.

(Copies of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)

Regulations Governing the Meat Inspection of the United States Department of Agriculture.

(Regulations Governing the Meat Inspection of the United States Department of Agriculture may be obtained from the Meat Inspection Division of the U. S. Department of Agriculture, Washington 25, D. C.)

Nongovernmental:

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Agricultural Chemists.

(Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists is published by the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists, P. O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington 4, D. C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.—Component products and ingredients used in the preparation of canned corned-beef hash shall be sound standard commercial kinds of good quality and excellent condition, selected, prepared, and handled to meet the detailed requirements pertinent to the particular type of product specified.

3.1.1 *Meat component.*—The skeletal beef and, when applicable, other permissible related meat component, used in preparing the product shall be boneless, free from foreign or objectionable odor or flavor, discoloration, extraneous matter, and other detrimental deterioration or damage, and shall be practicably free from cartilage, glandular tissue (except small glands usually remaining in well-trimmed boneless beef), major blood and lymph vessels, tendons, ligaments, serous and opaque membranes and blood clots. The meat used shall be sufficiently lean so that the end product will not exceed the fat content (by chemical analysis) specified. The meat component for the type II product shall be uncured skeletal beef derived from steers, heifers, or cows, in any combination exclusive of meat from cheeks, heads or hearts and as specified (see 3.2.2). Fresh or frozen beef received from suppliers for use in type II product shall, when specified (see 6.1), have been given a source inspection for conformance with requirements, and be duly identified by means acceptable to the responsible Government agent (see 4.2.3 and 5.3.1) and when frozen beef is used, it shall have been held in the freezer not to exceed 180 days, and shall be without evidence of detrimental freezer deterioration or other material damage.

3.1.2 *Potatoes.* — The potato component shall be prepared from well peeled sound, firm, white potatoes of good quality and shall be free from discoloration, off-odor, off-flavor, bruises, and other material damage, and practically free from eye, stem, or skin sections. The prepared potato product in the fresh, dehydrated state, or a mixture of two or more of such products shall be used as specified in accordance with the applicable formula. Appropriate sulfiting, or any other approved method of bleaching and preventing discoloration is permissible. The potato component shall be diced and the size of the dices, including those of reconstituted dehydrated potatoes, shall be approximately $^3/_{16}$ to $^3/_8$ inch.

3.1.3 *Onion component.*—The onion compopent shall be prepared from well peeled sound onions of pungent varieties of good quality,

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and shall be free from discoloration, off-odor, off-flavor, decay, soft portions and other material damage, and practically free from skin, root, stem, hard core, neck, and pithy or coarse sections. The prepared onion product in the fresh, or dehydrated free flowing powdered, or flaked (dry, cooked or reconstituted) form, or a mixture of two or more of such products shall be used as specified in accordance with the applicable formula. The size of the onion pieces, fresh or reconstituted, used in the type II product shall not exceed ½ inch in length.

3.1.4 *Curing agents.*—Curing agents shall be salt, and either or both sodium nitrate, sodium nitrite, (potassium nitrate, and potassium nitrite may be used) in any suitable combination and in amounts not exceeding those permitted by the Federal Meat Inspection Regulations of the U. S. Department of Agriculture.

3.1.5 *Seasoning.*—Seasoning refers to salt, sugar, dextrose, spices, and flavorings. The salt shall not be iodized and shall be white, refined sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents. The pepper shall be of the black variety, free from adulterants, shall possess the characteristic aroma and color and shall contain not less than 6.75 percent nonvolatile ether extract, or soluble black pepper flavoring may be used provided it contains a minimum of 4½ percent of total extractives of black pepper. The total extractives are the sum of nonvolatile ether extract and volatile oil content of the black pepper flavoring.

3.1.6 *Garlic.*—Unless otherwise specified, only the type I product may contain garlic prepared in either the fresh or the dehydrated-powdered-free flowing form. Fresh garlic when used shall be well macerated. The garlic component shall be prepared from well peeled sound garlic, and shall be free from discoloration, soft portions and other material damage, shall be practicably free from skins, roots, stems, hard cores, necks and coarse sections, and shall have the characteristic appearance, aroma and flavor associated with garlic product of good quality

3.2 **Description of types and formulas.**

3.2.1 *Type I, Standard.*—The type I finished product shall conform to 3.2.1.1 or 3.2.1.2 as specified, and shall be subject to acceptance or rejection at the time and place offered on the basis of conformance with 3.1 through 3.1.6, and with the physical characteristics according to 3.4 through 3.4.3.3.

3.2.1.1 *Formula A.*—Type I, formula A canned corned beef hash shall be prepared with beef (exclusive of cheek, head, or heart meat) and potatoes, curing agents, seasonings, and with or without onions, garlic, water, beef broth, or beef stock, and minor additives permitted by Federal Meat Inspection Regulations. In addition to the beef cited in 3.1.1, the use of cured beef or canned corn beef is permissible.

3.2.1.2 *Formula B.*—Type I canned corned-beef hash prepared according to this formula shall meet the requirements specified in formula A (3.2.1.1), except that one or more of the following meat products will be included on the basis of not more than 5 percent of the meat ingredient used, namely: beef cheek meat, beef head meat (both requiring removal of overlying glandular and connective tissues), and beef heart meat, exclusive of the heart cap (aorta, vena cava, gristle), and other nonmeat portions.

3.2.2 *Type II, Special.*—The type II canned corned-beef hash prepared from materials meeting the requirements in 3.1 through 3.1.6 and in accordance with formula A, or formula B herein, as may be specified, shall reflect the physical characteristics in the finished product according to 3.4 through 3.4.3.3, and as specified herein. The meat component derived from steers, heifers, or cows in any combination shall consist of skeletal beef only, exclusive of meat from cheeks, heads, or hearts. Beef that has been salted, cooked, cured or processed (retorted) shall not be

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used. The trimmed beef shall be cut or ground into pieces having a maximum dimension of ⅜ inch. Moisture defrosted beef shall be drained prior to subjection to curing or precooking so that its weight does not exceed that of the frozen beef prior to defrosting. If beef is moisture defrosted, the defrosting medium used shall not exceed 50° F. at the end of 1 hour after application.

3.2.2.1 *Formula A.* — Unless otherwise specified the type II, formula A, canned corned beef hash shall be prepared in accordance with the requirements of table I.

Beef component.—The prepared beef shall include all acceptable meat portions (tenderloins, flanks, hanging tenders, and skirts may be withheld at packer's option) derived from all involved cuts from the carcass and shall be used in the proportions as they exist in the carcass.

TABLE I

Ingredients	*Quantity*
Beef (trimmed and prepared, raw, fresh meat, fresh chilled or defrosted)	54 pounds
Potatoes (peeled and trimmed)	46 pounds
or	
Potatoes, dehydrated, diced	11 pounds
Onions (peeled and trimmed)	2½ pounds
or	
Onions, dehydrated	5.0 ounces
Sodium nitrite (or a combination of sodium nitrate and sodium nitrite, giving equivalent results)	2½ grams (0.088 ounce)
Salt	In a quantity consistent with finished product requirements (see 3.4.3.1)
Pepper, black, ground, or black pepper flavoring	0.6 ounce
Water	in a quantity consistent with finished product requirements (see 3.4.3.1)
Monosodium glutamate	optional

Preparation.—The preparation of the type II, formula A product shall be in accordance with method A or method B.

Method A—(braised meat). — The prepared meat shall be placed in a kettle or similar precooking vessel with the required amounts of pepper, salt, and sodium nitrite (or sodium nitrate and sodium nitrite), and cooked with dry heat (steam-jacketed kettle permissible). The cooked-out juices shall be retained and included in the finished product. The potato and onion components shall be prepared as described in 3.1, except that reconstitution of dehydrated potatoes and onions prior to use is not required. The components shall be combined, well mixed, filled into containers within 4 hours after precooking the beef and processed as required to result in an acceptable end product complying with 3.4.

Method B—(unbraised meat).—The prepared meat (unbraised) and other required components (dehydrated, unreconstituted potatoes only are suitable; fresh or reconstituted potatoes will cause excessive moisture) shall be well mixed and filled into the cans. The temperature of the product at time of filling shall not exceed 60° F. The filled cans shall be processed in such a manner as to produce an acceptable end product complying with 3.4.

3.2.2.2 *Formula B.* — Unless otherwise specified, the type II canned corned-beef hash subject to this formula shall be prepared from materials according to table II, in the manner specified, and shall meet the requirements relevant thereto.

Beef component.—The prepared beef shall include all acceptable portions (tenderloins, briskets, hanging tenders, plates, and flanks may be withheld at the packer's option) as existing, either in a straight carcass, side, or in matched forequarters and hindquarters as applicable, or in lieu thereof it shall comprise all acceptable meat portions as existing in beef chucks, in rounds, or both, with or without proportionate amounts of acceptable meat from loins and ribs.

Curing.—Curing of the beef may be accomplished by any conventional manner confined to a strictly dry-curing method or a dry-heat curing method without any added moisture, except that the permissible nitrate and nitrite may be dissolved in not more than one pint of water for each 100 pounds of prepared

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beef. Completion of curing the beef according to the dry curing method, or curing the beef according to the dry-heat curing method may be conducted simultaneously in conjunction with the pre-cooking process.

Precooking.—The beef component sized to a maximum dimension of approximately $^3/_8$ inch shall be placed in a kettle or suitable cooking vessel and be mixed with one ounce of ground black pepper to each 100 pounds of beef, or with a soluble black pepper flavoring as prescribed, in an amount giving equivalent results. The beef shall be precooked in its natural juices by the direct action of dry heat, such as in a steam jacketed kettle. The beef (either cured, partially cured, or in fresh state with uniformly applied curing ingredients as applicable) with the pepper properly distributed shall be precooked until the weight of the precooked beef does not exceed 70 percent of the weight of the trimmed fresh meat, and the meat shows a well-cured color without overcooking, scorching, or burning. The juices after precooking shall remain with the precooked beef after the beef has been weighed for appropriate shrinkage and formulation as prescribed.

Formulation.—The ingredients used shall be according to, and consistent with table II herein.

TABLE II

Ingredients	*Quantity*
Beef-precooked (trimmed, cure applied*, ground, etc., as specified)	12 pounds
Potatoes-raw (peeled, trimmed, diced)	55 pounds
or	
Potatoes-dehydrated (diced, suitably prepared) dry basis	12 pounds
Onions-raw (peeled, trimmed, sectioned)	3 pounds
or	
Onions-dehydrated (suitably prepared) dry basis	5 ounces
Juices from precooking plus any necessary additional water in a quantity consistent with finished product requirements.	
Salt-(total used for curing and seasoning) not exceeding	1.5 pounds

*The cure applied in the curing process shall consist of sodium nitrite or a combination of sodium nitrate and sodium nitrite giving equivalent results in quantity consistent with finished product requirements.

Mixing and can filling.—The formulated ingredients according to table II shall be thoroughly mixed without undue smearing or fragmentation and be filled into the cans within 4 hours after precooking the beef, and then promptly heat-processed and handled to produce an acceptable end product complying with 3.4.

3.3 Heat-processing and handling (all types).—Heat-processing shall be by suitable conventional means at temperatures and for such time as will result in thorough cooking and adequate sterilization of the canned product without burning, scorching, overcooking, or any other material damage. The heat-processed cans shall be promptly cooled. The finished product shall be handled in a manner to preclude damage (freezing, overheating, etc.) as applicable to the product, can, and shipping container.

3.4 Finished product characteristics (both types) .

3.4.1 *Product identification.*—The canned finished product shall exhibit the Federal Meat Inspection legend and in conjunction therewith, the intact approved label designating the manufacturer, the point of origin, the true name of the product, the net weight, and as applicable, such as type I product prepared according to formula B (3.2.1.2), the ingredients shown in their respective order of predominance in accordance with Regulations Governing Meat Inspection of the U. S. Department of Agriculture. The type II product shall also be identified as necessary (see 5.3.1 and 5.3.2.1).

3.4.2 *Exterior can and package characteristics.*—The cans shall be sound, not slack-filled, nor over-filled, and shall show perfect closure and concave ends indicating adequate vacuum, without bulging, distortion, or slack or loose tin. The cans shall be without damage such as rust, open seams, severe dents,

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leakage, contamination, deterioration, extraneous matter, evidence of freezing or defrosting, dripping moisture, severe condensation, or any objectionable condition as relevant to the product, can, and shipping container.

3.4.3 *Product characteristics.*—The corned-beef hash as removed from the can shall reflect physical characteristics and meet the requirements pertinent to the product as specified herein. The product tested in accordance with 4.3.2, shall be readily removable in the form of a compact, semi-solid mass, conforming to the shape of the can and without liquefaction, dripping moisture, or accumulations or pockets of gelatinous matter, air, moisture, and rendered fat. The meat shall be thoroughly cured and shall have a bright, cooked, corned-beef color. The ingredients shall be well distributed and the meat and potatoes shall appear as distinct particles. The potato and onion components shall be free from skins, eyes, stems, and dark sections, and shall be well blended with the meat particles. The product shall be tender, practically free from tendons, gristle, coarse sections, and free from discoloration, and detrimental deterioration or damage. It shall be palatable when eaten hot or cold, and the flavor shall not be bland, extremely pronounced, or otherwise objectionable, the fat, moisture and salt content, the can vacuum, and the net weight, shall meet the requirements in 3.4.3.1 through 3.4.3.3. The end product shall be neither mushy nor so dry that it adheres to the sides of the can when removed, and it shall have the characteristic flavor, texture, aroma and appearance associated with well-prepared corned-beef hash of good quality.

3.4.3.1 *Analytical requirements.* — Analytical requirements of the product shall be as listed in table III.

Unless otherwise specified, the type I product may be accepted without benefit of chemical analysis provided, the physical fat content, the physical moisture content and consistency, and the salt flavor are typical and not considered excessive.

3.4.3.2 *Can vacuum.*—The canned product, after heat-processing and when tested (as applicable) according to 4.3.2 and 4.3.2.1, shall show a vacuum with an average of not less than 5 inches for containers of net weight up to and including 2 pounds and an average of not less than 2 inches for containers of net weight heavier than 2 pounds. Unless otherwise specified, the type I canned product may be accepted on the basis of conformance with the exterior can characteristics specified in 3.4.2, including indication of adequate vacuum.

3.4.3.3 *Net weight.*—The net weight, after heat processing and when tested in accordance with 4.3.2 shall be as specified in 5.1.1.

3.5 **Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act.** —All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and the regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.6 **Meat Inspection Act.** — The canned corned-beef hash shall be prepared only in an establishment which is regularly operated under the supervision of the Meat Inspection Division, Agricultural Research Service, U. S.

TABLE III.

Type	Percent fat		Percent moisture		Percent salt (NaCl)	
	Sample unit	Maximum lot average	Sample unit	Maximum lot average	Sample unit	Maximum lot average
I	15.00	15.00	72.00	72.00	3.50	2.50
II	15.00	10.00	72.00	70.00	3.50	2.00

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Department of Agriculture, and shall be inspected, passed, and marked in accordance with the Regulations Governing Meat Inspection of the U. S. Department of Agriculture.

3.7 Sanitation and workmanship. — The canned corned-beef hash shall be handled and delivered under the same sanitary conditions as govern the handling and movement of similar products within and between establishments maintained under the supervision of Meat Inspection Division, Agricultural Research Service, U. S. Department of Agriculture.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling. — Samples of the finished product covered by this specification and samples of materials, components, or constituents entering into the preparation of the finished product may be taken at any time by the Government inspector and tested to determine compliance with the requirements. Any individual unit (shipping container or can) of the product not meeting the requirements of 3.4.2 need not be opened for examination of the product, but shall be rejected and then promptly replaced by the contractor with acceptable units. When 5 percent or more (by count) of the total of cans in the lot lack acceptable exterior characteristics, the involved lot of the product shall be rejected without necessity for opening any of the cans from such lot.

4.1.1 *Product sampling procedure.* Unless otherwise specified in the invitation for bids, sampling of the canned product as a means to determine conformance shall be conducted as applicable to type I and type II, specified herein. Product sampling shall necessarily be held to an absolute minimum and the following procedure shall serve as a tentative guide for opening cans and examination and disposition of corned-beef hash from opened sample cans. Insofar as practicable, opening and examining the canned corned-beef hash (except official laboratory samples) shall be conducted at the contractor's plant or facility since, unless otherwise specified and arranged, the opened can and its contents shall remain the product of the contractor who will replace the same at his expense with intact cans of the product indicating conformance.

4.1.1.1 *Sampling, type I.*—Sampling 3 percent (by count) of type I canned corned-beef hash from cans representative of the delivery lot as selected at random by the responsible Government agent should normally suffice, provided the product from at least 95 percent of all cans opened and examined meets the requirements, otherwise additional cans need to be opened and the product examined. Except for official laboratory samples, the number of additional cans to be opened in the event initial sampling (3 percent) of type I canned corned-beef hash reveals nonconformance will be at the option of the contractor to assure that the number of cans of the product meeting the requirements is at least 95 percent of the total number of cans of the product opened and examined, otherwise the involved lot of the canned product offered for delivery shall be rejected.

4.1.1.2 *Sampling, type II.* — The type II canned corned-beef hash prepared under direct official supervision may reasonably be expected to meet the requirements with respect to proper selection, use, and handling of materials prior to the time of canning and heat-processing. Therefore, unless otherwise specified, sampling 1 percent (by count—including official laboratory samples) of type II canned corned-beef hash from cans representative of the delivery lot as selected at random by the responsible Government agent should normally suffice, provided the product from at least 95 percent of all cans opened and examined meets the requirements, otherwise additional cans need be opened and the product examined. The number of additional cans to be opened in the event initial sampling (1 percent) of type II canned corned-beef hash from the delivery lot reveals noncon-

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formance (except official laboratory samples) will be at the option of the contractor to assure that the number of cans of the product meeting the requirements is at least 95 percent of the total number of cans of the product opened and examined, otherwise the involved lot of the canned product offered for delivery shall be rejected. The fat and salt content on a lot-average basis for the type II product shall be determined according to 4.1.1.2.1.

4.1.1.2.1 *Type II, sampling procedure for fat, moisture, and salt content.* — The fat, moisture, and salt content of the type II finished product on a lot-average basis shall be determined by chemical analyses conducted in official Federal Government laboratories in accordance with Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists. The sample of the canned product used for official testing shall be derived and handled as specified herein. During the course of normal preparation of each lot, which shall comprise not more than any single day's production, there shall be withheld and set-aside therefrom at least one can as selected at random by the responsible Government agent from each 500 cans after filling, but prior to closing and heat-processing. Such accumulated open cans and product contents representing the particular production lot shall be promptly placed in a 38° F. or lower temperature without freezing. At the time of completion of the designated daily (or less) production lot, the combined product contents from the selected cans shall be thoroughly mixed, then repacked in clean, sterile cans, closed, sealed, and promptly heat-processed in the usual manner. Such cans shall be suitably identified as the "test-lot" in conjunction with the properly identified production lot from which it is derived. After heat-processing, three cans as a unit shall be officially selected at random from the finished "test-lot" and promptly forwarded to the designated Federal Government laboratory as the official composite sample for chemical analyses for the fat, moisture, and salt content. In addition, another unit of three cans similarly selected shall be withheld from the "test-lot" as an official reserve sample for possible subsequent analyses at the option of Government. The cans remaining in the "test-lot" after withholding the official sample cans may be included in the production lot from which derived. Fat, moisture, and salt content analyses results obtained by the contractor will not be a consideration in determining whether the reserve sample is analyzed. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor by the Government inspector promptly after acceptance of the lot.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 *General.*—Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the site of preparation, both during and after production, at a suitable point in transit, or after delivery to the point of destination.

4.2.2 *Processing and packing plant inspection.*—The passing as satisfactory of any detail of processing or materials, shall not relieve the contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.3 *Identification of type II inspected material.* –When specified (see 6.1), fresh or frozen beef received from suppliers for use in type II product shall have received a source inspection for conformance with requirements and shall be duly identified (see 5.3.1 and 6.1).

4.2.4 *Packaging, packing, and marking material inspection.*—In lieu of acceptance testing, inspectors may accept manufacturer's Certificate of Compliance, which shall certify that packaging, packing, and marking materials used comply with the requirements of this specification.

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4.2.5 *Final inspection.*—Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Chemical analyses.*—Unless otherwise specified, chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the methods of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists in effect on date of invitation for bids.

4.3.1.1. *Pepper.*—Test for *ground black* pepper—nonvolatile ether extract (4-gram sample). Test for *soluble black pepper flavoring*—volatile oil (25-gram sample).

4.3.1.2 *Moisture.*—Moisture shall be determined as follows: Use the entire contents of can as sample, and comminute in a Waring or similar blender. Dry, with lids removed, quantity of sample representing approximately 2 grams of dry material for 16 to 18 hours at 100° C. to 102° C. in an air oven (mechanical convection preferred). Use covered aluminum dish at least 50 mm. in diameter and not exceeding 40 mm. in depth. Cool in desiccator and weigh. Report loss in weight as moisture.

4.3.1.3 *Fat.*—Fat shall be determined as follows: Use applicable paragraph in Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists, using petroleum ether; prior aqueous extraction of carbohydrates is unnecessary.

4.3.2 The physical characteristics of the product, including the net weight content, as taken from any can tested shall be determined only after holding the unopened can for at least 24 hours after heat processing, in temperatures ranging from 60° to 80° F. or until the product has attained a similar internal temperature.

4.3.2.1 *Can vacuum.*—Can vacuum for the type II product, or when required for type I, shall be determined as follows: After retorting, sample cans shall be selected which are free of dents and other visible damage, placed on end, and allowed to reach a temperature of 60° to 80° F., and the vacuum taken with a vacuum gage. If the vacuum reading is taken at an altitude other than that of the packer's plant, the reading shall be corrected for the difference in altitude.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

The definitions and applications of the levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Federal Standard No. 102 for civil agency procurement.

5.1 Packaging.—The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1, 5.1.2, or 5.1.3, as specified (see 6.1), and unless otherwise specified, the type I product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.3.

5.1.1 *Can sizes and respective net weight contents.*—Unless otherwise specified, type I canned corned-beef hash may be delivered in any one conventional size of can of the net weight content specified. The applicable size, and net weight content of can for the type II product shall be as specified. The net weight content of the cans for either type I or type II product shall be as specified in accordance with table IV herein.

TABLE IV.—*Can sizes and net weight contents*

(Code)	Sizes (approximate)	Round can codes	Net weight content
(a)	3 by 3½ inches	300 by 308	12 oz.
(b)	3 by 4 7/16 inches	300 by 407	15 oz., 15½ oz., 1 lb.
(c)	6 3/16 by 6 inches	603 by 600	5 lbs. — 12 oz.
(d)	6 3/16 by 7 inches (No. 10)	603 by 700	6 lbs. — 12 oz.

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5.1.2 *Level A.*—The product shall be packaged in open-top style round metal cans with soldered side seam and compound-lined, double-seamed ends, and the cans shall be hermetically sealed. The cans shall be made from not less than commercial 0.25-pound electrolytic tin plate and shall be coated overall inside with an enamel furnished by the can manufacturer in accordance with best commercial practice and as suitable for the product. Cans shall be coated outside in accordance with 5.1.2.1.

5.1.2.1 *Exterior can coating.*—Cans shall be coated outside in accordance with 5.1.2.1.1, or 5.1.2.1.2, as specified (see 6.1) except all cans of type II product with a net weight content of 1 pound or less shall be outside coated in accordance with method 1 in 5.1.2.1.1.

5.1.2.1.1 *Method 1.* — The cans shall be coated outside with a coating conforming to type I or II, or when specified (see 6.1), type III of Military Specification MIL–C–10506.

5.1.2.1.2 *Method 2.*—Commercially coated cans or cans without an exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.1.3 *Level C.*—Suitable commercial packaging will be acceptable.

5.2 **Packing.**—The product shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.1, 5.2.2, or 5.2.3, as specified (see 6.1). Unless otherwise specified, the type I product shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.3.

5.2.1 *Level A.*—Six of the 6-pound, 12-ounce cans or six of the 5-pound, 12-ounce cans, packaged in accordance with 5.1.2, arranged 3 in length and 2 in width, shall be packed on end in snug-fitting containers complying with 5.2.1.1 or 5.2.1.2, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1.1 *Sub-level 1 (fiberboard box).*—The container shall be a fiberboard box made and sealed in accordance with type II, class 2, grade 2, style RSC–SL of Federal Specification PPP–B–636. The container shall be strapped in accordance with the appendix to Federal Specification PPP–B–636 except that 2 flat straps shall be used. One strap shall be applied lengthwise over the top, ends, and bottom, and the second strap shall be applied girthwise, centered over the top, sides, and bottom. The longer strap shall be applied first.

5.2.1.2 *Sub-level 2.*

5.2.1.2.1 *Fiberboard box.*—The container shall be a fiberboard box made and sealed in accordance with type I or II, class 2, grade 3, style RSC of Federal Specification PPP–B–636. The fiberboard box shall be strapped in accordance with the appendix to Federal Specification PPP–B–636 except that 3 flat straps shall be used. Two straps shall be applied lengthwise over the top, ends, and bottom, and the third strap shall be applied girthwise, centered over the top, sides, and bottom. The longer straps shall be applied first.

5.2.1.2.2 *Nailed wood box.*—Alternatively, a nailed wood box, constructed and strapped in accordance with class 2, style 4 or 4½, for type 2 load of Federal Specification PPP–B–621 may be used.

5.2.1.2.3 *Wirebound wood box.*—Alternatively, a wirebound wood box, constructed and closed in accordance with style 2, 2A, or 3, for class 3 use, type 2 load, of Federal Specification PPP–B–585 may be used, except that faceboards made from groups I, II, or III woods shall be not less than ¼-inch thick, and faceboards made from group IV woods shall be not less than $^{7}/_{32}$-inch thick.

5.2.2 *Level B.*—The cans of the product shall be packed on end in a snug fitting fiberboard box, nailed wood, or wirebound wood box, constructed in accordance with type I or II, class 1 of Federal Specification PPP–B–636; class 1, style 4 or 4½, for type 2 load of Federal Specification PPP–B–621; or style 2, 2A, or 3 for class 1 use, type 2 load, of Federal Specification PPP–B–585, respec-

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tively. The flaps of the fiberboard boxes shall be securely sealed with a good quality adhesive, applied throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps, or by a combination of stitching one set of flaps prior to packing and sealing the other flaps with adhesive. When flaps are stitched, the stitches shall be distributed so as to fasten all flaps securely together over the entire area of contact between the inner and outer flaps and to prevent lifting of free edges and corners of the outer flaps.

5.2.3 *Level C.*—The cans of the product shall be packed in containers which are acceptable by common carriers for safe transportation to point of destination specified in shipping instructions at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Shipping containers shall comply with the carrier rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 *Type II product.*—Unless otherwise specified, the type II product prepared under special supervision shall be suitably identified by means acceptable to the responsible Government agent.

5.3.2 *Civil agencies.*

5.3.2.1 *Unit containers.*—Unless otherwise specified, any commercial labeling in accordance with 3.4.1 or additional labeling that complies with the Federal Meat Inspection Act and regulations promulgated thereunder will be acceptable under this specification.

5.3.2.2 *Shipping containers.*—Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be legibly marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123. In addition the product, other than type I, shall be identified by appropriate marking as type II, in accordance with the contract or order under which the shipment is made, and as applicable, the name of the contractor, serial number of the contract or order, date of packing, and other pertinent information as specified by individual agencies.

5.3.3 *Military agencies.*

5.3.3.1 *Cans.*—The cans shall be labeled in accordance with 5.3.3.1.1 or 5.3.3.1.2, as applicable. The following information shall appear on all cans:

NAME OF PRODUCT (In letters larger than any others used for the label)
Net weight of contents
Date packed
Name and address of packer
Inspection legend
Establishment number
Ingredient statement
Any other information required by the Federal Meat Inspection Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5.3.3.1.1 *Level A cans.*—The cans shall be labeled in accordance with 5.3.3.1.1.1 or 5.3.3.1.1.2, as specified (see 6.1).

5.3.3.1.1.1 *Method 1.* — The information specified in 5.3.3.1 and 5.3.3.1.1.1.1 shall be lithographed in black ink on one end or on the body of the can in accordance with Military Specification MIL-L-1497, except that the date of packing shall be embossed in accordance with Military Specification MIL-L-1497.

5.3.3.1.1.1.1 *Special purpose 12-ounce can.*—In addition to the marking specified in 5.3.3.1, the following information shall appear on one end or on the body of the can:

TO HEAT
Submerge can in boiling water **or**
Place **open** can over flame (avoid burning or overheating).

5.3.3.1.1.2 *Method 2.*—Commercial labeling will be acceptable provided the information specified in 5.3.3.1 appears on the can.

5.3.3.1.2 *Level C cans.*—Commercial labeling will be acceptable provided the information specified in 5.3.3.1 is included.

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5.3.3.2 *Shipping containers.* — Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. — Procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Type, and, when applicable, the formula, can size and net weight content of product required (see 1.2 and section 5).

(*b*) If required, beef received from suppliers for use in type II product shall have received a source inspection (see 3.1.1 and 4.2.1).

(*c*) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see Section 5).

(*d*) Method of exterior can coating required for level A packing (see 5.1.2.1).

(*e*) Sub-level required for level A packing (see 5.2.1).

(*f*) Method of can labeling required for level A packing (see 5.3.3.1.1).

6.2 Methods and sub-levels applicable to level A packaging and packing.

6.2.1 *Method 1 and sub-level 1.*—Method 1 and sub-level 1 should be used when a high degree of water resistance is desired and when extreme handling and climatic conditions and extended outside storage are anticipated.

6.2.2 *Method 2 and sub-level 2.*—Method 2 and sub-level 2 should be used when a moderate degree of water resistance is desired and when extreme handling and climatic conditions and extended outside storage are not anticipated.

6.3 This specification does not include all types, formulas, and manner of preparation of canned corned-beef hash that are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

6.4 If for any particular purpose samples with bids are necessary, they shall be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated.

6.5 **Contractor's inspection.**—The contractor's obligation and responsibility requires such performance and his detailed inspection to assure that the product conforms with the specification prior to its submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.6 **Destination inspection.**—When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Army—QM
Navy—SMC
Air Force.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 10 cents each.

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